

HUNTING WITHOUT RIFLE: AFRICAN ANIMALS AT HOME FILMED FOR THE "WONDERLAND OF BIG GAME."

PHOTOGRAPHS BY MAJOR A. RADCLIFFE DUGMORE.

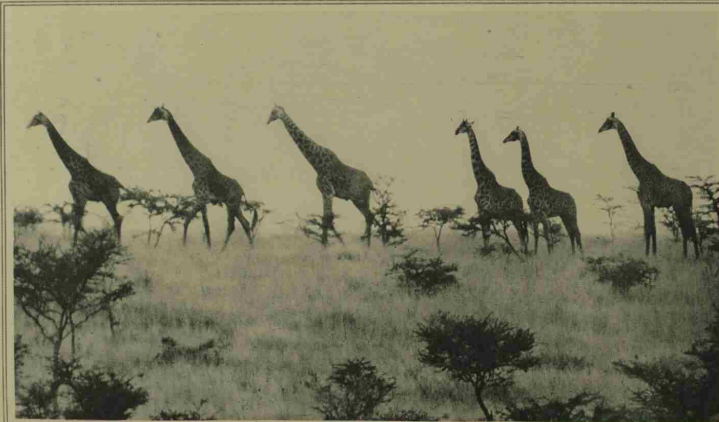
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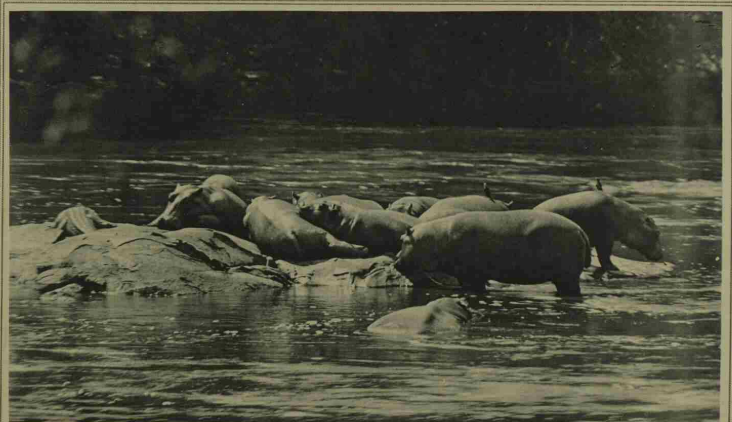
LIKE A LINE OF TROOPS DEPLOYED IN EXTENDED ORDER: A LARGE HERD OF KUDU ON THE AFRICAN PLAINS—PART OF A REMARKABLE FILM AT THE POLYTECHNIC HALL, IN REGENT STREET, WITH



OF WILD ANIMALS IN THEIR NATIVE HAUNTS, TAKEN BY MAJOR A. RADCLIFFE DUGMORE, AND NOW BEING SHOWN IN "THE WONDERLAND OF BIG GAME," A DESCRIPTIVE COMMENTARY BY THE PHOTOGRAPHER.



PECULIARLY WELL BUILT FOR OBSERVATION PURPOSES, AND ACCUSTOMED TO ENHANCE THEIR HEIGHT BY GOING TO THE TOP OF A HILL TO EXTEND THEIR VIEW: A GROUP OF GIRAFFE, DWARFING THE LITTLE TREES OF THE AFRICAN BUSH.



HOBNOBBING WITH A CROCODILE (ON THE EXTREME LEFT) AND SOME WITH SENTINEL RHINO BEARS PERCHED ON THEIR BACKS: A FAMILY PARTY OF HIPPO ON THE TANA RIVER IN BRITISH EAST AFRICA.

We have already given (in our issue of April 14) examples of Major Radcliffe Dugmore's remarkably interesting photographs of African animals in the wild state, as shown in "The Wonderland of Big Game," at the Polytechnic, one of the most striking natural history films ever presented on the screen. In view of the excellence of the photographs, however, we need hardly apologise for returning to the subject. The creatures previously illustrated included zebra, a lion and lioness, and a rhinoceros prepared to charge, all taken at very close quarters. As we then pointed out, the charm of this film is that it affords the spectator all the thrills of big game hunting without the painful element of slaughter. At the same time, the photographing of wild beasts at short range frequently demands as high a courage as that of any sportsman, if not higher. Every animal in the film—and they are of many varieties—is shown alive and happy, and in its natural surroundings. Herds of giraffe are seen coming down to a water-hole to drink, having been photographed, all-unconsciously, at

abundantly close range, so that all their curious attitudes and movements are visible, and even the expression on their faces. A note supplied with the hippopotamus group says: "These animals are getting very scarce and are extremely shy. During the war they were shot for their fat, which is greatly prized." A somewhat similar photograph of a school of "Hippo," by Mr. Russell Roberts, appeared in our issue of January 3, 1920, and describing it he said: "It is not often that one is able to get a close view of hippopotami lying in masses. They require to be entirely undisturbed and unsuspecting before they will relinquish their usual caution and, giving up all thoughts of danger, lie sleeping in family heaps. They are protected by a few rhino-birds, which can be seen seeking an insectivorous diet on their recumbent hosts." From the name of these birds, taken in conjunction with the photograph, it may be assumed that they are equally at home either with rhinoceros or hippo. They perhaps serve as sentinels, their behaviour giving warning of an intruder's approach.